

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Wednesday September 3rd Afternoon Session part 2

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=65HW5bKpPAI
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or separate committee work session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer during an evening budget hearing session. (Note: The specific board name is referenced as the Council/County Council reviewing departmental budgets).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Council members including Jim, Matt, Eugene, and others.
 - **Board Officials & Presenters:** Fred (Emergency Communications/Safety), Emily Anderson (Court Administrator), Judge Judy Calhoun (Delaware Circuit Court 1), Judge John Fe (Circuit Court 4/Presiding Judge), Judge Doug Matt (Circuit Court 3), and Nikki Bosin (New CASA Director).
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly specified.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the excerpt.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed during this portion of the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:00 Emergency Communications & Safety Budgets (Fred's Department)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Fred presented updates regarding software maintenance contracts (such as the Motorola radio contract and Rave software), noting that software maintenance has been shifted out of the county budget where possible. Discussion ensued regarding upcoming major capital needs, including a \$2.05 million projection for radios, anticipated future costs for phone system updates, and long-term funding strategies ahead of changes to public safety LIT (Local Income Tax) slated around 2028.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:05:32 Courts, Probation, & CASA Budgets (Fund 138 & Associated Grants <U+2014> Presented by Emily Anderson & Judges)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator), joined by Judge Judy Calhoun, Judge John Fe, and Judge Doug Matt.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Emily Anderson presented the true comparison budgets for courts, probation, and CASA programs, detailing proposed 4% salary adjustments, line item deductions, and grant funding shortfalls. Key topics included:
 - Absorption of a juvenile probation officer's health insurance benefits (\$26,000) into County General to prevent job loss due to flat state grant allocations (\$100,000 JCC grant).
 - Reductions in 2026 jury trial lines (\$50,000 reduction in County General, paired with jury fee fund allocations) due to downward trending trial volume.
 - A request for a new administrative assistant position (416 wage scale) to prevent extreme burnout of the single current court administrator. (After council discussion regarding salaries, the 4% across-the-board cost-of-living increases and the new position were discussed for removal/revisiting).
 - Adjustments to remove health benefits from user fee funds to comply with statutory guidelines limiting user fees to supplementing salaries.
 - 2025 budget givebacks across transcription fees (185–138), professional services (310), and jury trials (390), alongside a transfer to purchase remaining courtroom jury chairs in the current year (7,800).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**

- Judge Judy Calhoun strongly advocated for the approval of the new administrative assistant position to retain Emily Anderson and prevent administrative collapse.
 - Judge John Fe echoed support for retaining vital staff.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Extensive line-item adjustments and budget givebacks were negotiated and agreed upon by consensus, though final formal adoption was deferred to subsequent sessions.
- **01:00:42 CASA / Galcasa Budgets & State Grants (Funds 160, 1212, Capacity Building, Wellness, VOCA)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson and Nikki Bosin (New CASA Director)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed CASA operational budgets, state grants, and federal VOCA grant allocations. Noted the elimination of unproductive stipend programs, management of mileage reimbursement via United Way and grant funds, web master/social media line items, and the phasing out of the Wellness grant as remaining funds are depleted.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **01:13:22 Title IV-D Court & Incentive Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson and Judge Doug Matt (Circuit Court 3)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed Title IV-D court shared incentive accounts (8895), office supply adjustments funded by shifting training/food and lodging costs, and federal 66.6% reimbursements. Judge Doug Matt clarified the governance and voting process required between the prosecutor, clerk, and court to expend shared IV-D incentive funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational and administrative review; no formal roll call vote.
- **01:32:00 Jury Fee Fund & Family Recovery Court (FRC) Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the Jury Fee Fund (Fund 85) collections and the FRC Grant (Fund 89) shortfall. Emily Anderson requested a \$2,640 adjustment to cover a discrepancy in an FRC staff member's salary to prevent a pay cut.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to incorporate the necessary FRC salary adjustment into County General.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Omitted: The transcript does not feature a general public comment or citizen forum period; discussions were strictly confined to municipal board members, staff, and presenting

department heads.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **01:36:20** Due to the hour (past 9:00 PM), the Council addressed remaining agenda items and scheduled the continuation of budget hearings.
 - A special meeting was announced for the following morning at 8:15 AM, followed immediately by the reconvening of budget hearings.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **01:36:51** The meeting was officially placed **in recess** by the presiding officer.
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